

Kaeden Wellman

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SUMMARY

I'm a college freshman. I build software and embedded projects with Claude, teach what I build, and have been elected to leadership in every volunteer organization I've stayed with for over a year.

EDUCATION

University of Colorado Colorado Springs *Incoming Fall 2026*

B.S. Electrical Engineering · Division II Track & Field (400m / 300m hurdles)

Arizona College Prep High School — Chandler, AZ *Graduating May 2026, Magna Cum Laude*

4.0 UW / 4.36 W · College-level Physics and Calculus

PROJECTS

Halle Reviews — Solo Full-Stack Build *Diane & Bruce Halle Foundation, 2026*

- AI-assisted grant review application that replaces the foundation reviewers' improvised Zoom + NotebookLM + ChatGPT workflow; each grant moves through an LOI → Application → Funded → Completed lifecycle with LLM summarization at every stage, driven by editable Markdown rubrics
- Sole developer, ~6,200 lines of TypeScript/JavaScript in three weeks: Vite + React 18 + TypeScript + Tailwind on Vercel, Node + Express on Railway, push-to-main continuous deployment
- Multi-provider LLM layer (Anthropic, OpenAI, Google) behind a single streaming SSE interface with a server-side persisted key store; real Microsoft Entra ID sign-in (MSAL + jose JWT validation) and per-user workspace persistence

Lightsaber Duel Game — Microchip DevDay Hackathon Winner *Best Project Award, 2026*

- Built a physical lightsaber dueling game linking a Microchip Curiosity board (CircuitPython, IMU, NeoPixels, LCD, audio) to a browser game via the Web Serial API
- Streamed motion data as JSON over USB serial at 10 Hz; shipped three deployable modes (classic side-by-side, first-person, combined)
- Only non-intern in a field of college interns; debugged the full stack solo using Claude to understand root causes, not just fixes
- Repo: github.com/kaedenwellman/lightsaber

Gyftloop — Co-founder *gyftloop.com · with wellmanaz*

- Live product: track birthdays and anniversaries, then receive three tailored gift ideas one week before each occasion via automated email
- Vanilla JS SPA on Vercel Edge Functions with Neon Postgres and Auth0 (PKCE, no SDK); integrated a product marketplace API for live catalog data, OpenAI embeddings for candidate reranking, and Resend for scheduled reminder emails
- Composite ranking model blends semantic similarity, price fit, and top-rated flags, with a heuristic fallback when the LLM key isn't configured

Teen Startup Kits — Founder *Arizona LLC, 2026*

- Direct-to-consumer Shopify business selling service-business starter kits for teens ages 13–18
- Filed the LLC through the Arizona Corporation Commission; designed three-tier product structure (Basic/Pro/Premium), pricing, margins, and a creator affiliate model
- First product live: Window Cleaning Starter Kit

Link Crew Website — Arizona College Prep

- Interactive site replacing a static PowerPoint for the Link Crew program; dual-audience with a gated section for selected leaders
- Built and deployed on GitHub Pages; branded to school colors and logo

HOA Website

- Web build for a local Homeowners Association

TEACHING & COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

CircuitPython Instructor — Microchip DevDay, Pima Community College *July 2026*

- Invited by the DevDay program's creator to co-lead the class after winning the hackathon; first student-to-instructor transition in the program's history
- Taught embedded CircuitPython to a class of about 25 college students, most with no prior coding experience
- Guided students through progressive hands-on projects on the Microchip PyKit Explorer board; ran one-on-one debugging sessions with students who got stuck

Event Coordinator — Arizona Best Buddies Friendship Walk *2025–2026*

- Coordinated logistics for the statewide Friendship Walk; drove a measurable increase in underclassman participation from my school
- Chapter officer supporting Friendship Ball, Hot Cocoa Run, Trunk-or-Treat, and fundraising

Commissioner, Link Crew — Arizona College Prep *2025–2026*

- Senior leadership role: event planning, supply coordination, donor outreach, multi-school coordination

Volunteer Hurdle Coach *2+ years*

- Coach youth and middle school hurdlers; extend the mentorship model of the coach who worked with me

Athletic Leadership Council Officer — Arizona College Prep

WORK EXPERIENCE

Assistant Chef & Staff Trainer — Gosan Poke and Roll (family-owned restaurant) *March 2024–Present*

- Multi-role at a family-owned small business: kitchen operations, staff training, and social media content
- Trained new employees on prep, POS, and service standards; ran a high-volume kitchen through peak service
- Hands-on exposure to the operational realities of running a small business: inventory, labor, and customer experience

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python, JavaScript, HTML/CSS
- **AI & APIs:** Claude API, OpenAI API, prompt engineering, streaming SSE, Web Serial API
- **Web:** React, Vite, Tailwind, Node, Express, Vercel, Railway
- **Auth & Data:** Microsoft Entra ID (MSAL, JWT), Auth0 (PKCE), Neon Postgres
- **Embedded:** CircuitPython, Microchip PyKit Explorer, Microchip Curiosity board, IMU/NeoPixel/LCD peripherals
- **Tools:** GitHub, VS Code, Shopify, Google Apps Script

CERTIFICATIONS & AWARDS

- **Anthropic AI Fluency** · **Anthropic Claude 101** (Claude Corps prerequisites — completed)
- 2026 Superintendent's Outstanding Citizenship Award
- Best Project Award, Microchip DevDay Hackathon (2026)
- 2025 Track & Field MVP · 2024 AZ Track & Field All-Academic Team · 2023 Freshman MVP
- CTE Software and Design Knight Award
- Food Managers Certification · Food Handlers Permit